

Ohio River Trail Council



1100 Pennsylvania Av
Monaca, Pa 15061
724-728-2625

MINUTES

SEP 29, 2011

3:30PM

MONACA MUNICIPAL BLDG

MEETING CALLED BY	Chief Executive Chairman – Vincent Troia
TYPE OF MEETING	Monthly
FACILITATOR	Chief Executive Chairman – Vincent Troia
NOTE TAKER	Mario Leone / Mindy McKee Secretary

Attendees: Patricia Majors, , Diane Kemp, Doniele Russell, Mario Leone, Laura Rubino, Chuck Jones, Nicholas Baran, Sean Garrigan, John Van Jura, Chad McMillen. Linda Tice, John Szatkiewicz, Susan Catanzarita, Nathan Peluso, Justin Battalini

Agenda Topics: D&O Policy Vote, Port of Pgh, Commission, SGA-Monaca/EPA Grant, Financials, North Shore Feasibility Study, South Shore Trail Construction Funding, Wallace Run Launch, CSX Koppel Bridge, Trail Ride Series, Water Trail/Butterfly Preserve, Community Day/VO North/Lock 57 Park, Penn DOT Wayfinding, Thom Jones, President Monongahela River Chapter, Lewis and Clark Trail Heritage Foundation.

DISCUSSION	Vincent Troia welcomed everyone, called the meeting to order and everyone in attendance introduced themselves.
DISCUSSION	Approval of Minutes — Motioned: Justin Battalini –2 nd : Pat Majors – all in favor -- passed
DISCUSSION	PPC Grant - Dr. Troia state that Monaca and Bridgewater PPC water trail launch point projects were completed and the Ohioville and Rochester projects are in progress.
DISCUSSION	Wallace Run – Doniele spoke about the ORTC Port of Pittsburgh Commission \$10,000 funding for the Wallace Run - Beaver Falls Project. Doniele also discussed the Beaver River Conservation Plan and the Beaver County Comprehensive Plan.
DISCUSSION	Koppel/CSX abandoned property - Acquisition steps includes further research regarding liability and funding issues. SGA to evaluate property and supply recommendations regarding inclusion in the north shore study.
DISCUSSION	D & O insurance policy - A motion to circulate and approve D & O insurance policy at the next meeting was made by John Szatkiewicz and seconded by Pat Majors. A vote was held and it passed unanimously.

DISCUSSION	Butterfly Preserve - John Szatkiewicz updated the status of the butterfly garden at the Ohioville Park.
DISCUSSION	Trail Ride Series - Nathan Peluso commented on the Trail Ride Series saying that the group is averaging 10 people per ride, and the future ride schedules are posted on the website. Nathan commented that the Power 32 project is of a regional effort to create maps of all the trails in the region to better market our assets for tourism. Report to be published in November 2011.
DISCUSSION	South Shore - Doniele stated that the DCNR grant has been closed out and Sean Garrigan (project consultant) spoke about how the ORTC should start to look into obtaining the funding for construction.
DISCUSSION	North Shore: Sean thanked the group for selecting his firm for the North Shore project, discussed future meeting location and times, project time schedule, stakeholder interviews, and that he has obtained all the GIS mapping for the north shore from Beaver County. EPA Study: Mario reported that the project is moving along nicely and we are scheduled to be hosting Public Open Houses in the four respective municipalities on Wednesday morning Midland Borough and Coraopolis in the evening from 6:30 to 8:30 pm. and on Thursday morning in Aliquippa and Monaca in the evening from. Representative from both the Washington and Philadelphia regional offices are planning to attend these events and all are invited to attend to show our strong support for this project.
DISCUSSION	Meeting was adjourned. Next meeting to be held November 22, 2011.
DISCUSSION	Lewis and Clark Trail - On October 3, 2011, Dr. Vincent Troia and Mario Leone Jr. met with Mr. Thom Jones. President Monongahela River Chapter Lewis and Clark Trail Heritage Foundation 412.207.2593 thom@thomjones.com Mr. Jones asked the Ohio River Trail Council to support Pittsburgh as a proper launch point for the Lewis and Clark National Historic (Land & Water) Trail. The proposed Ohio River Land and Water Trails follows the route of the Lewis & Clark Expedition. Mr. Jones provided information regarding the Pennsylvania Historical Markers Program. In addition, funding opportunities were discussed regarding the ORT and the Lewis & Clark Trail.

Ohio River Trail Cycling Club

Trail Ride Series Schedule 2011 – Twenty Rides

04/09/2011	Little Beaver Creek Greenway - Lisbon, OH.
04/23/2011	Allegheny River/Sandy Creek Trail - Franklin, PA.
05/07/2011	Mill Creek Greenway – Canfield, OH.
05/21/2011	Ghost Town Trail - Dilltown, PA.
06/04/2011	Stavich Trail - New Castle, PA.
06/18/2011	West Penn Trail/Westmoreland Heritage Trail - Slickville, PA.
07/02/2011	Mahoning Shadow Trail - Fordham, PA.
07/10/2011	Butler-Freeport Trail - Freeport, PA.
07/31/2011	Three Rivers Heritage Trail - Pittsburgh, PA.
08/06/2011	Ohio & Erie Canal Towpath Trail – Mustill Store, OH
08/28/2011	Wheeling Heritage Trail - Wheeling, WV.
09/04/2011	Montour Trail - McDonald, PA.
09/25/2011	Panhandle Trail – Walkers Mill, PA.
10/02/2011	Allegheny Highlands Trail – Frostburg, MD.
10/09/2011	Oil Creek State Park Trail - Oil City, PA.
10/16/2011	Youghiogheny River Trail - Connellsville, PA.
10/23/2011	Armstrong Trail - Rosston, PA.
10/29/2011	Western Reserve Greenway - Champion, OH.
11/05/2011	Conotton Creek Trail - Bowerstown, OH.
11/12/2011	Deckers Creek Trail - Morgantown, WV.

Schedule subject to change; please refer to email notifications.



www.OhioRiverTrail.org

Please visit our [website](http://www.OhioRiverTrail.org) and register to receive ORTC correspondence.





Matthew Cangioli
Regional Manager

RECEIVED

JUN 20 2011

BCPC

500 Water Street - J200

Jacksonville, FL 32202

Phone: (904) 279-3824

FAX: (904) 245-4525

E-Mail: Matthew_Cangioli@CSX.com

June 15, 2011

Beaver County Planning Commission
810 Third Street
Beaver, PA 15009

Dear Sir/Madam:

Please be advised that CSX Transportation, Inc. is considering abandonment of a portion of its rail line from Railroad Milepost PLK 0 to Milepost PLK 2.39 a distance of 2.39 miles in Koppel, Beaver County, PA, as depicted on the attached map.

This action requires Surface Transportation Board approval and Federal Regulations 49 C.F.R. 1105.7(3)(i) require that CSXT develop a response to the following statement:

"Based on consultation with local and/or regional planning agencies and/or a review of the official planning documents prepared by such agencies, state whether the proposed action is consistent with existing land use plans. Describe any inconsistencies."

CSXT would appreciate your comments regarding current and future land use in relationship to the rail line.

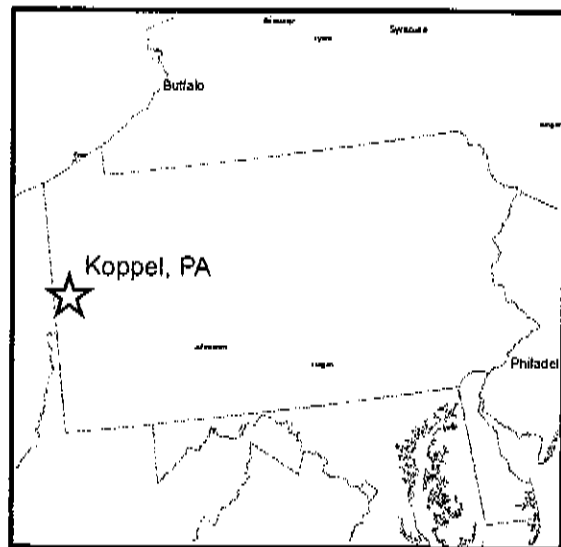
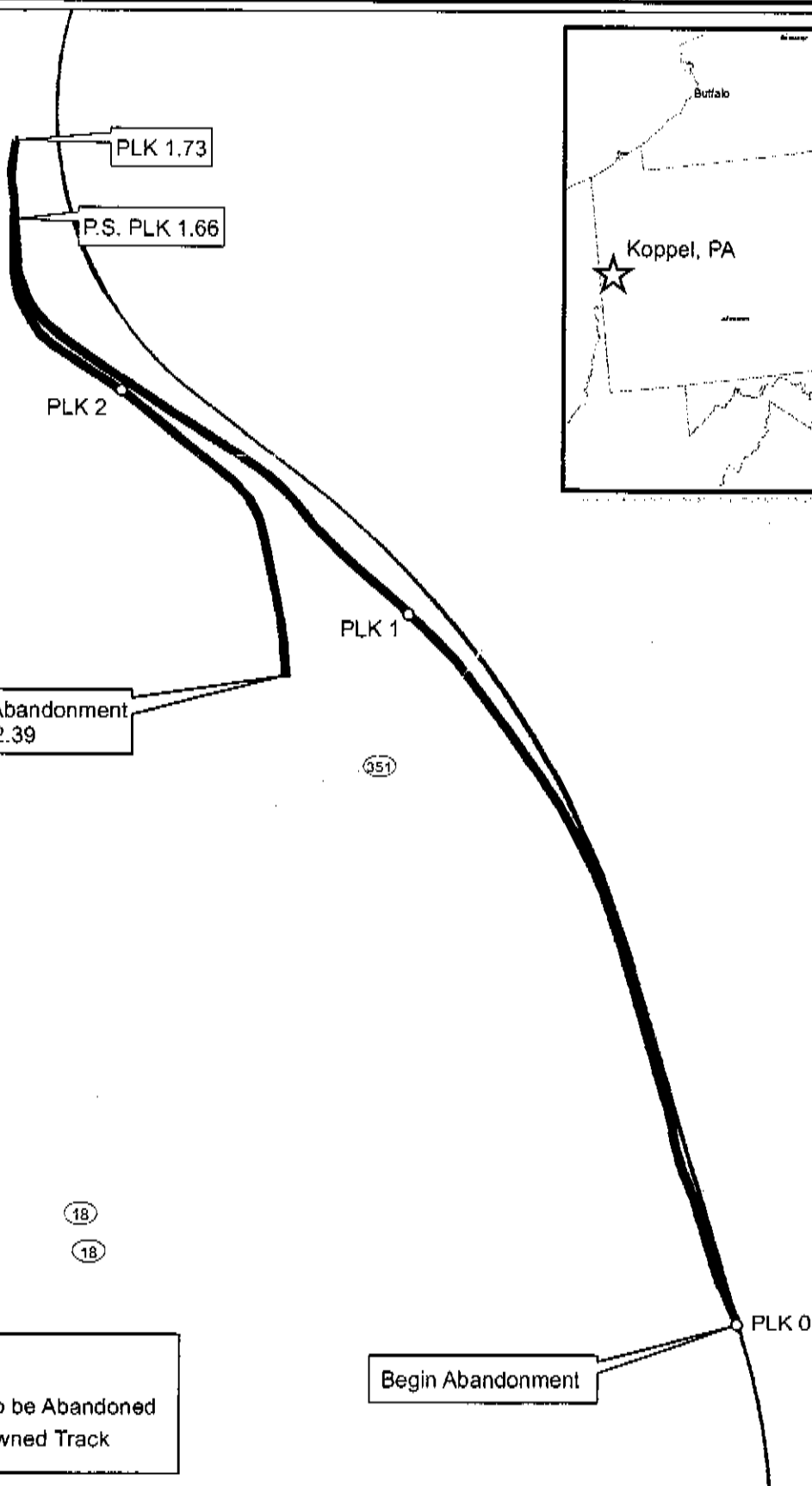
As further information, CSXT will provide a preliminary environmental report in the coming weeks which will outline the scope of the proposed salvage activity and include any comments received from your office. This environmental report can be sent electronically by email or through the United States Postal Service (USPS). Please notify me, Matthew_Cangioli@csx.com if you wish to receive the report electronically. If we do not receive notification, it will be mailed via USPS.

Further enclosed, please find a distribution list of all parties that have been copied of the proposed action.

Sincerely,

Matthew Cangioli

Attachment



LEGEND

- Track to be Abandoned
- CSX Owned Track



Creation Date: June 2, 2011

PITTSBURG SUBDIVISION CSX Transportation, Inc. Proposed Abandonment

PLK 0.0 to PLK 2.39, a distance of 2.39 mile
Koppel, Beaver County, Pennsylvania - STB Docket No. AB 55 (Sub-No 708X)

0 400 800
Feet

CSX Real Property, Inc.
PA 007 1044752
V1/M0 (V08544)
V1/SL-41A (V08548)

Distribution list of all parties that have been copied of the proposed action:

Beaver County Planning Commission
810 Third Street
Beaver, PA 15009

U.S. Environmental Protection Agency
Region 3
1650 Arch Street
Philadelphia, PA 19103

US EPA – STATE
Department of Environmental Protection
Rachel Carson State Office Building
400 Market St.
Harrisburg, PA 17101

U.S. Fish & Wildlife Service
Pennsylvania Field Office
315 South Allen Street, Suite 322
State College, PA 16801

U.S. Army Corps of Engineers
Pittsburgh District
William Moorhead Federal Building
1000 Liberty Ave., Rm. 2200
Pittsburgh, PA 15222-4186

USDA – Natural Resources Conservation Service
Butler Service Center
625 Evans City Rd.
Butler, PA 16001-8704

Tom Corbett
Governor of the Commonwealth of Pennsylvania
225 Main Capitol Building
Harrisburg, PA 17120

Pennsylvania Historical and Museum Commission
400 North Street – 2nd Floor
Harrisburg, PA 17120-0093

Pennsylvania Public Utility Commission
Post Office Box 3265
Harrisburg, PA 17105

National Park Service
Northeast Region
Attn: Regional Director
U.S. Custom House
200 Chestnut St., Fifth Floor
Philadelphia, PA 19106

Pennsylvania Game Commission
2001 Elmerton Ave.
Harrisburg, PA 17110

Pennsylvania Fish and Boat Commission
1601 Elmerton Ave.
Post Office Box 67000
Harrisburg, PA 17106-7000

Pennsylvania Dept. of Transportation
Keystone Building
400 North Street
Harrisburg, PA 17120

National Geodetic Survey
Via email: Simon.Monroe@noaa.gov



Matthew Cangiolosi
Regional Manager

500 Water Street – J200
Jacksonville, FL 32202
Phone: (904) 279-3824
FAX: (904) 245-4525

E-Mail: Matthew_Cangiolosi@CSX.com

June 15, 2011

Pennsylvania Historical and Museum Commission
400 North Street – 2nd Floor
Harrisburg, PA 17120-0093

230306



RE: CSX Transportation, Inc., Proposed Line Abandonment, Koppel, Beaver County, Pennsylvania, STB Docket Number AB 55 (Sub No. 708 X)

Dear Sir/Madam:

Please be advised that on or about July 15, 2011 CSX Transportation, Inc. (CSXT) expects to file with the Surface Transportation Board (Board) a Notice of Exemption seeking authority to abandon service from The Line (as referenced above) in Koppel, Pennsylvania. The track is known as the Koppel Steel Lead, begins at Railroad Milepost PLK 0, and ends at Railroad Milepost PLK 2.39. This line was a part of the Pittsburgh and Lake Erie Railroad (P&LE) that was formed on May 11, 1875. The P&LE served the steel mills of the greater Pittsburgh area. The approximate 2.39 total miles of track are located in Koppel, Beaver County, Pennsylvania, STB Docket Number AB 55 (Sub No. 708 X).

The above referenced 2.39 mile line has not generated any originating, terminating or overhead traffic in over 2 years. No new rail oriented business is expected to develop and the line is out of service and no longer required for operating purposes. The proposed action is to abandon the line and remove the rail, cross-ties, and possibly the upper layer of ballast.

In connection with rail lines that are to become the subject of applications for authority to abandon, Federal Regulations at 49 CFR 1105.8(d), require that a Historic Report be submitted to the State Historic Preservation Officer prior to filing with the Surface Transportation Board. In accordance with those Regulations, I am attaching a Historic Report covering the above-proposed abandonment.

Since there are no structures over 50 years old, I would appreciate receiving a letter from your office confirming that this project will have no impact upon cultural resources.

If you have questions, please feel free to call me.

Sincerely,

Matthew Cangiolosi

Attachment

ENTERED
Office of Proceedings
JUN 22 2011
Part of
Public Record

cc: Surface Transportation Board – OEA
395 East Street, SW
Washington D.C. 20423

HISTORIC REPORT



**CSX TRANSPORTATION, INC.
Koppel, Beaver County, PA
DOCKET AB-55 (SUB-NO. 708X)**

1105.7(e)(1)

PROPOSED ACTION AND ALTERNATIVES. Describe the proposed action, including commodities transported, the planned disposition (if any) of any rail line and other structures that may be involved, and any possible changes in current operations or maintenance practices. Also describe any reasonable alternatives to the proposed action. Include a readable detailed map and drawings clearly delineating the project.

CSXT proposes to abandon approximately 2.39 miles of its rail line from Railroad Milepost PLK 0 to Railroad Milepost PLK 2.39, known as the Koppel Steel lead, in Koppel, Beaver County, Pennsylvania.

Notice of Exemption Language:

The above referenced 2.39-mile line has not generated any originating or terminating traffic in over 2 years.

Abandonment of this line will result in the removal of the rail, crossties, and possibly the upper layer of ballast. CSXT does not intend to disturb any sub grade or sub grade structures. Finally, the operations and maintenance of this line will cease.

The only alternative would be not to abandon and to pass the opportunity costs of retaining the line to all other CSXT customers. This would not be a prudent utilization of carrier resources.

The map which delineates the proposed project is attached. (See Attachment 1).

1105.8(d)

- (1) A U.S.G.S. topographic map (or an alternate map drawn to scale and sufficiently detailed to show buildings and other structures in the vicinity of the proposed action) showing the location of the proposed action, and the locations and approximate dimensions of railroad structures that are 50 years old or older and are part of the proposed action.**

Attached are copies of the 1980-01-01 quadrangle topographic map prepared by the U.S. Department of Interior Geological Survey.

The line to be abandoned has been identified by a heavy red line with black dashes. (See Attachment 2)

There are no CSXT-owned structures that are 50 years old or older that may be eligible for listing in the National Register that are part of the proposed action.

- (2) A written description of the right of way (including approximate widths, to the extent known), and the topography and urban and/or rural characteristic of the surrounding area:**

The right of way width along this line varies from approximately 100 feet to 160 feet in width. Koppel Steel is located on the top of the hill. It was served by CSXT until the track was taken out of service in 2008. The Track has a switch back along with curve and grade issues. The area is heavily wooded and parallels the Beaver River. Maintenance was very expensive due to the geometry and heavy winter conditions.

- (3) Good quality photographs (actual photographic prints, not photocopies) of railroad structures on the property that are 50 years old or older and of the immediately surrounding area:**

Not applicable

- (4) The date(s) of construction of the structure(s), and the date(s) and extent of any major alterations, to the extent such information is known:**

Not applicable

- (5) A brief narrative history of carrier operations in the area, and an explanation of what, if any, changes are contemplated as a result of the proposed action:**

This line was a part of the Pittsburgh and Lake Erie Railroad. (P&LE). - The P&LE was formed on May 11, 1875. They served the steel mills of the greater Pittsburgh area. P&LE was also known as the "Little Giant" due to the amount of tonnage that it moved in proportion to its route miles. P&LE was taken over by CSX Transportation in 1992. Koppel Steel is located on the top of the hill and was served by CSXT until the line was put out of service in 2008. Koppel Steel is still served by Norfolk Southern with line-haul movements and interchanging of carloads between NS and CSXT in Pittsburgh.

Upon receiving abandonment authority, Applicant's operations and maintenance over this line will cease and the track will be salvaged.

- (6) A brief summary of documents in the carrier's possession, such as engineering drawings, that might be useful in documenting a structure that is found to be historic:**

Not applicable

- (7) An opinion (based on readily available information in the railroad's possession) as to whether the site and/or structures meet the criteria for listing on the National Register of Historic Places (36 C.F.R. 60.4), and whether there is a likelihood of archeological resources or any other previously unknown historic properties in the project area, and the basis for these opinions (including any consultations with the State Historic Preservation Office, local historical societies or universities):**

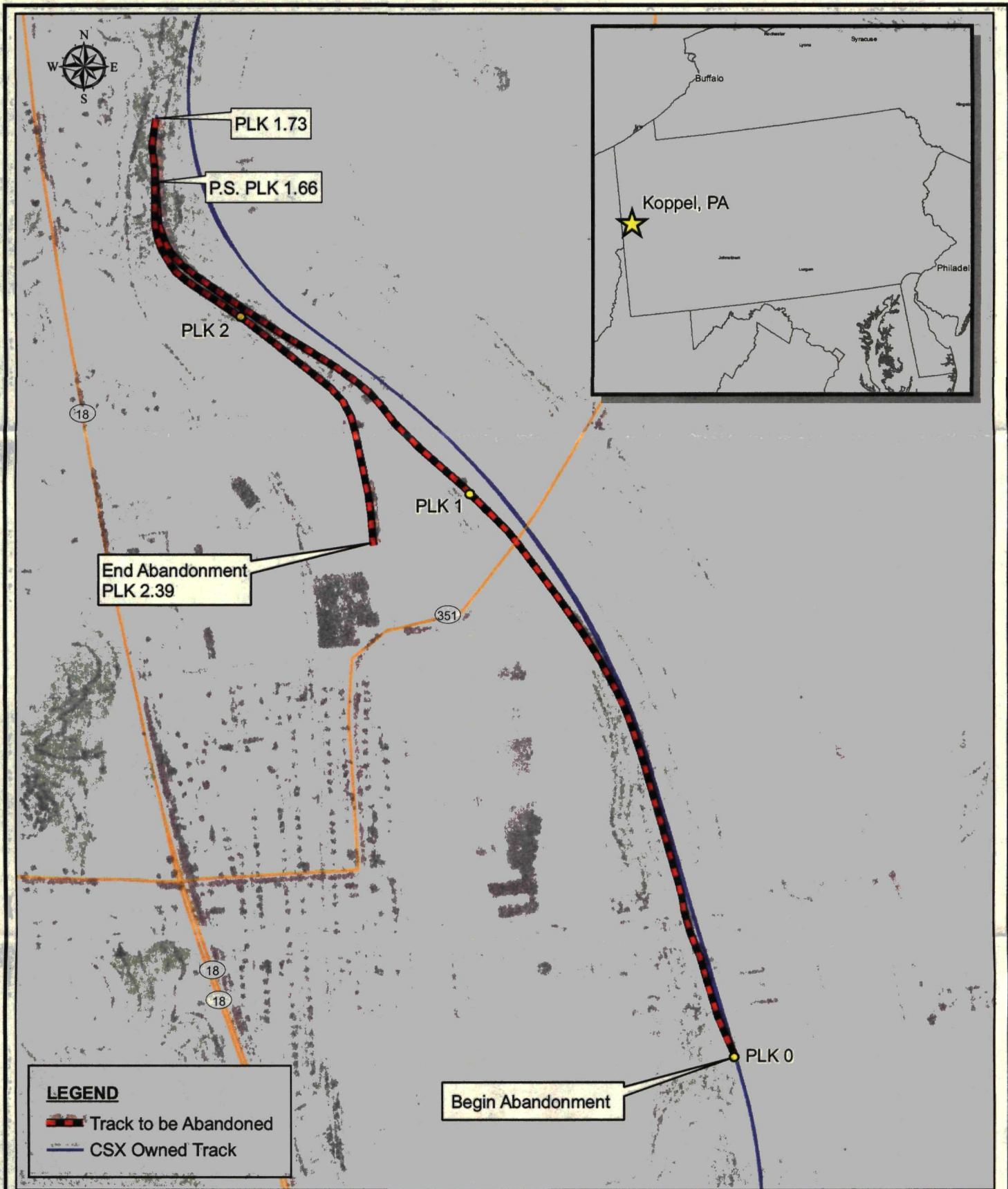
We do not know of any significance or uniqueness to any particular structure that would warrant your consideration, since to our knowledge, it is not associated with any event that has made a

contribution to the broad patterns of history; or were not associated with lives of persons significant to our past; do not embody the distinctive characteristics of a type, period, or method of construction; and do not represent a significant and distinguishable entity whose components may lack individual distinction and have not or may not be likely to yield information important in prehistory or history.

We do not know of any archeological resources or any other previously unknown historic properties in the project area.

- (8) A description (based on readily available information in the railroad's possession) of any known prior subsurface ground disturbance or fill, environmental conditions (naturally occurring or man-made) that might affect the archeological recovery of resources (such as swampy conditions or the presence of toxic wastes), and the surrounding terrain.**

The line was disturbed during construction by cuts and fill and any archeological resources that may have been located in the proposed project area would have been affected at that time versus during the proposed salvage operations associated with rail removal. Our records do not indicate that any swampy conditions exist or that any hazardous material spills have occurred within the project area.



LEGEND

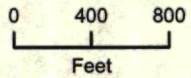
- Track to be Abandoned
- CSX Owned Track



Creation Date: June 2, 2011

PITTSBURGH SUBDIVISION
CSX Transportation, Inc.
Proposed Abandonment

PLK 0.0 to PLK 2.39, a distance of 2.39 mile
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CSX Real Property, Inc.
 PA-007-1044752
 V1/40 (V09544)
 V1/SL-41A (V09548)

Ohio River Trail Council Meeting Sign-In Sheet

Project: Ohio River Trail
 Facilitator: Dr. Vincent Troia
 Place/Room: Monaca, Pa

Date: 29-Sep-11
 Time: 3:30pm

PRINT NAME	ORGANIZATION	TITLE	PHONE	EMAIL
1. Patricia Majors	MUCO ORTC	Chair	724-775-3501	patriciamajors@comcast.net
2. DIANE Kemp	MICLANC	MGR	724-643-4170	midlandbch@gmail.com
3. Donzelle Russell	BEPC	Planner	724-968-0793	andrus.donzelle@yahoo.com
4. MARGO LEONE	Monaca Boro	Manager	724-775-9663	MANAGER@MONACAPA.NET
5. LARA RUSINO	BECD	Vice President	724-728-8610	LRUSINO@BEAVERCOUNTRYCBO.ORG
6. CHUCK JONES	MACKIN ENG.	TRAFFIC ENGINEER	412-788-0472	cmj@mackinengineering.com
7. NICHOLAS BARAN	SEA	CIRCUIT DESIGNER	814-443-1073	nbaran@sea.com
8. SEAN GARRIGAN	SEA		814-443-1073	sgarrigan
9. JOHN VAN JURA	ORTC	Board member	412-527-8754	JEVANJURA@yahoo.com
10. Chad McMiller	ORTC	Solicitor	724-375-6683	cmcmiller@yourlawfirm.net
11. LINDA De Tice	ORTC	BOARD	724-643-8422	57fbird@comcast.net
12. John Szatkiewicz	ORTC	Board	724-643-8422	57fbird@comcast.net
13. SUSAN CATANZARITA	INDUSTRY BORO	BORO COUNCIL	724-643-3554	scatanzarita@westernbeaver.org
14. NATHAN PELUSO	ORTC	Cycling Club	412-874-3444	npeluso@hotmail.com
15. Justin Battalini	ORTC	Board	724-513-4724	jbattalini@hotmail.com
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